Mercedez Callenes, PhD

Assistant Professor of Global Affairs | Director, Latin American Development Studies Minor

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political economy of development in Latin America; gender-sensitive policies and rural development; peace and conflict studies, political violence, and critical infrastructure; poverty reduction strategies.

EDUCATION

PhD, Public Policy and Political Economy 2021
University of Texas at Dallas, School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

MS, Applied Economics 2013
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics

BS, Economics 2006
Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú, Department of Economics

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Trinity Washington University, Washington, DC

College of Arts and Sciences, Global Affairs Program

Acting Program Chair, Global Affairs, Politics, and History Fall 2026

Director, Latin American Development Studies (LADS) Minor 2024–present

Assistant Professor of Global Affairs 2021–present

University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Graduate Research Assistant, NSF CRISP Grant (Award 1541199) 2016–2021

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Fulbright Scholar — Fulbright Program, U.S. Department of State, for graduate study in the United States 2011

Doctoral Dissertation Research Award, Office of Graduate Education, University of Texas at Dallas 2019

Gamma Sigma Delta, International Agricultural Honor Society (University of Illinois chapter) 2013

Graduate Fellowship, College of ACES, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign 2011–2013

AYRE International Research and Learning Fellowship, Njala University, Sierra Leone 2011

Finalist, National Research Competition, CIES and International Development Research Centre (IDRC) 2009

Scholarship, LACEA and Global Development Network (GDN) 2008

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Holmes, J. S., Palao, A., **Callenes, M.**, Ortiz Silva, N., & Cárdenas, A. (2023). Attacking the grid: Lessons from a guerrilla conflict and efforts for peace in Colombia: 1990–2018. *International Journal of Critical Infrastructure Protection*, 42, 100621. doi:10.1016/j.ijcip.2023.100621

2. Palao Mendizabal, A., Holmes, J. S., **Callenes, M.**, Ortiz, N., & Cárdenas, A. (2022). Using hotspot analysis to prioritize security efforts in Colombian critical infrastructure, a focus on the power grid. *Security Journal*, 35(3), 801–822. doi:10.1057/s41284-021-00300-7

3. Palao Mendizabal, A., Holmes, J. S., Ortiz, N., **Callenes, M.**, & Cárdenas, A. (2021). A hotspot analysis of critical hydrocarbons infrastructure in Colombia: ELN and FARC attacks on Colombian pipelines. *Applied Geography*, 126, 102376. doi:10.1016/j.apgeog.2020.102376

4. Holmes, J. S., Palao Mendizabal, A., De La Fuente, D. S., **Callenes, M.**, & Cárdenas, Á. (2021). Paramilitary violence in Colombia: A multilevel negative binomial analysis. *Defence and Peace Economics*, 32(2), 193–219. doi:10.1080/10242694.2019.1624067

5. Palao Mendizabal, A., Holmes, J. S., **Callenes, M.**, & Cárdenas, Á. (2019). Crossing thresholds: The use of spatial analysis to identify intensification of the Colombian conflict. *Conflict Resolution Quarterly*, 37(2), 177–187. doi:10.1002/crq.21265

6. Gitter, S. R., Weber, J. G., Barham, B. L., **Callenes, M.**, & Valentine, J. L. (2012). Fair trade-organic coffee cooperatives, migration, and secondary schooling in southern Mexico. *Journal of Development Studies*, 48(3), 445–463. doi:10.1080/00220388.2011.598511

7. Barham, B. L., **Callenes, M.**, Gitter, S., Lewis, J., & Weber, J. (2011). Fair trade/organic coffee, rural livelihoods, and the "agrarian question": Southern Mexican coffee families in transition. *World Development*, 39(1), 134–145. doi:10.1016/j.worlddev.2010.08.005

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"Civil Protests as a Means to Defuse or Escalate Conflict? Evidence from Colombia." *Latin American Studies Association (LASA) Congress*, Vancouver, Canada. — May 2023

"Using Hot Spot Analysis to Prioritize Security Efforts in Colombian Critical Infrastructure, a Focus on the Power Grid." *23rd Latin America Social and Public Policy Conference (LASPP)*, Center for Latin American Studies, University of Pittsburgh. — Mar. 2019

"The Pacification Process and the Dynamics of Colombian Violence." *New Security Challenges: Organized Crime and Urban Conflict in the Americas*, Universidad del Pacífico, Lima, Peru. — Oct. 2018

"Paramilitary Violence in Colombia: A Multilevel Negative Binomial Analysis." *22nd Latin America Social and Public Policy Conference (LASPP)*, Center for Latin American Studies, University of Pittsburgh. — Mar. 2018

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

I-ExCEL Institute (Instructor Excellence × Confidence Equals Leadership), Trinity Washington University — 2022–2023

Graduate Teaching Certificate, Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Texas at Dallas — 2020

Dynamic Models for Social Scientists, University of Essex at UK - Summer School — 2018

Workshop: Sustainable Agriculture, Environment, and Community Development, Njala University, Sierra Leone — 2011

Econometric Techniques for Micro and Panel Data, Universidad de los Andes, Colombia — 2008

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Socio-economic Researcher, Environmental Resources Management (ERM), Lima, Peru — 2014–2015

Research Assistant, Dept. of Agricultural and Consumer Economics, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign — 2011–2013

Assistant Researcher, Group for the Analysis of Development (GRADE), Lima, Peru — 2007–2011

Research Intern, Dept. of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison — 2008–2009

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Statistical and technical: Stata, ArcGIS, LaTeX
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

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